Communication Skills

Quiz 2 study guide

Course LA10760 · summarised from the Active-Listening/Meetings lecture notes and lectures L7–L11

What's new since Quiz 1

- Quiz 1 covered short stories, plot, Modernism, and essay-writing basics (lectures L2–L8).
- This set covers **professional and interpersonal communication**: active listening, the Rogerian strategy and principled negotiation, running meetings, and building a resume and job application — plus **persuasive/readerly writing** (L9).
- The past-paper appendix from Quiz 1 is carried over at the end, because its Quiz 2 concept section (meetings, resumes, Rogerian argument, Harvard Negotiation Project) turned out to **match this exact material** — see the updated trend analysis on the final page.

#	Section	Source
1	Active listening & professional presence	Lecture notes (May 19)
2	Writing an essay: templates & style manuals	L7
3	Writing well: final points	L8
4	Persuasive writing & readerly style	L9
5	Negotiations: Rogerian strategy & Principled Negotiation	L10
6	Meetings, virtual conferencing, resumes & applications	L11
7	Practice MCQs and answer key	Drill
8	Past-paper appendix (Quiz 1 & 2, transcribed)	Carried over
9	Trend analysis (updated)	Carried over

★ One-page cheat sheet

Memorise these lists and names

Six steps to active listening

- 1 Pay full attention 2 Suspend judgment 3 Pause and reflect
- 4 Ask clarifying questions 5 Summarize 6 Share
- Good reflecting (paraphrasing): sums up, checks understanding, reassures, communicates acceptance/respect, non-judgmental

Rogerian strategy

- Goal: create an atmosphere for meaningful negotiation, not a step-by-step method
- Can be non-negotiable if parties are at loggerheads, or lead to non-optimal compromises
- **9 key steps**: common ground → know audience → introduce problem → acknowledge opposite side → define own position → put both sides together → move to conclusion → hear opposite party's final take → finalize by editing the main idea

Principled Negotiation (Harvard Negotiation Project)

- Roger Fisher, William Ury & colleagues, founded 1979
- **4 principles**: separate people from the problem · focus on interests not positions · invent options for mutual gain · insist on objective criteria

Meetings — before calling one

- Best for reaching consensus on a narrowed-down issue; NOT for brainstorming from scratch
- Ask first: "What do I hope to get out of it?"
- Prepare time, decide invite list (include contributors, exclude agenda-pushers and silent members), write and circulate an agenda

Writerly vs readerly

- **Writerly**: dense, complex, demands work from reader
- **Readerly**: simple, precise, chronological, no contradictions, no complexity
- Fix: condense weak verb + bulky noun → active verb ("is indicative of"→indicates; "is capable of"→can)

Meeting roles & records

- Chairperson: sets ground rules, states agenda (+changes), opens discussion
- Minutes: taken by someone other than the chair, identified in advance; short action minutes are best
- Virtual meetings: prepare material extra well, vary vocal intonation, expect time lags, get to the point

Resume & application

- Letter/email of application: one page, 4 parts — heading, intro, body (most relevant experience), closing + enclosures
- Resume: summary (not narrative) of activities, repeats letter's key points, highlights top qualifications, languages/tech skills, start date, references

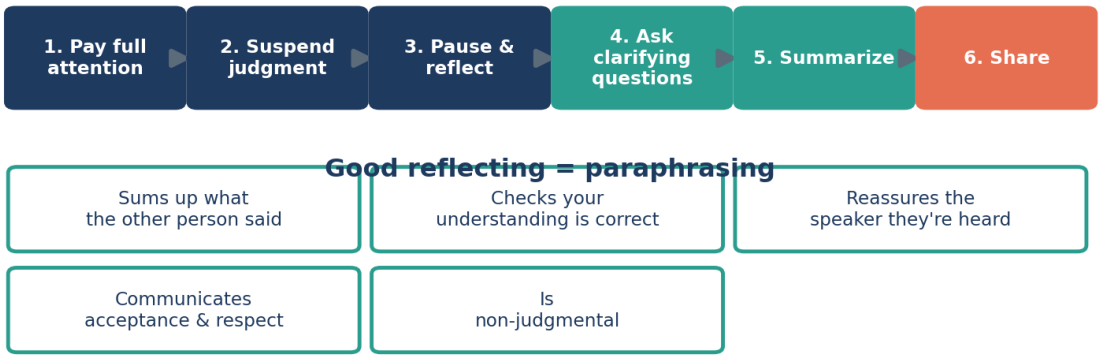
Key names & sources

- Carl Rogers (1902–87): humanist/client-centered psychologist
- Young, Becker & Pike (1970): adapted Rogers to rhetoric
- Roger Fisher & William Ury: Principled Negotiation, Harvard
- *Sully: Miracle on the Hudson* (2016): negotiation-under-pressure example

1 Active listening & professional presence

Lecture notes, May 19 2025 (parts from a Stanford Report)

Six steps to active listening



Steps 1–3 are about receiving; 4–6 are about responding

Good reflecting (paraphrasing)

- Sums up what the other person has said, making it clearer and more real.
- Checks out that you have understood and interpreted the meaning correctly.
- Reassures the speaker that they are being heard.
- Communicates acceptance, respect, and concern. Is non-judgmental.
- Avoid both aggressive and submissive behavior; use humor and information correctly.

Body language and public presentations

- Avoid lax, closed, judgmental postures, and critical or mocking facial expressions.
- Stay relaxed — focus on the work at hand, not your hands and feet. Sit or stand upright but comfortably.
- Make eye contact with the audience; be receptive to reactions; be welcoming (extend an arm, smile).
- Be humble and sincere; express gratitude and respect.

Note: Rogerian strategy, Principled Negotiation, resume design, references, and meeting dos-and-don'ts also appear in this lecture note — they're covered in full depth in Sections 5 and 6, since L10/L11 expand on each with more detail.

2 Writing an essay: templates and style manuals

Lecture L7 · templates from Graff and Birkenstein, They Say, I Say

Style manuals across disciplines

Field	Manuals
Technical and scientific research writing	IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers) manual; APA (American Psychological Association) manual
Social sciences and humanities	MLA Handbook; Chicago Style Manual; Harvard Style Manual; APA Style Manual

Template moves

Part	Move	Shape of the template
Introduction	Begin with a debate	"In discussing X, one often claims ___ (Author, page). On the one hand, ___ argue ___. On the other hand, ___ contend ___. Others maintain ___. My own view is ___."
Introduction	State your position	"I've always believed that ___ has had its merits and demerits... At the same time, I believe ___ and also ___."
Introduction	Refer to critical sources	"A number of scholars have suggested that ___. In their recent work A and B claim ___." Cite as you go.
Summary	Main argument and quotations	"[Author] hails ___ and his hero presents a glorious example of ___ by ___... He admits: '___'. Accordingly, I reaffirm ___."
Body	Disagree, with reasons	"Scholar A is mistaken about ___ because she ignores the fact that ___."
Body	Agree and add your own take	"X's theory is extremely useful here because it sheds light on ___."
Body	Agree and disagree at once	"Though I concede ___, I still insist that ___."
Body	Remain undecided	"I am on two minds about ___. On the one hand I agree that ___. On the other hand, I am not sure whether ___."
Conclusion	Repeat yourself, but differently	"In sum, my argument is ___." / "To conclude, I would like to reiterate that ___."

Transitions for the conclusion: as a result · after all · in short · finally · to summarize · in sum · simply put. **Whenever you cite or borrow, give a reference in parentheses** following the style manual you are working with.

3 Writing well: final points

Lecture L8 · Written communication

Writerly writing: the erroneous sentence (common mistakes)

Sentence	Error the slide names
"Being the most spectacular event in the nation, newspapers were obligated to devote major coverage to the hurricane."	Modifier problem: newspapers were not the most spectacular event
"He had arrive at his home town."	Tense (wrong verb form after 'had')
"Either the physicians in this hospital or the chief administrator are going to have to make a decision."	Subject-verb agreement (agrees with the nearer subject)

Complex academic writing and creative writing

- **Complex/academic:** a dense passage from Michel Foucault's *Discipline and Punish* (1977) — the opposite of readerly writing.
- **Creative writing:** similes and neologisms from Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things* ("getting-outedness", "Bar Nowl").

Verb tenses, parallel structure, and voice

- Keep **one tense** for the main discourse; shift tense only to mark a real change in time frame (Purdue OWL, NIU).
- **Pronouns** must be consistent in person and number.
- **Parallel structure:** pairs and lists must follow the same grammatical pattern ("skating and reading", not "skating and to read").
- **Passive voice** (subject acted upon) is wordy and unfocused — prefer active, except when the actor is unknown, irrelevant, deliberately vague, or you're stating a general truth ("Mistakes were made"; "Rules are made to be broken").
- **Readerly writing:** simple and precise, grammatical, chronological, without contradictions or complexity.

4 Persuasive writing & readerly style

Lecture L9 · Communication process, effective persuasion, sentence-level editing

Communication process and effective persuasion

- The lecture opens with two topics: the **communication process**, and **the use of language in effective communication**.
- **Effective Persuasion** (Purdue University Writing Lab): "Persuasive writing seeks to convince its readers to embrace the point-of-view presented by appealing to the audience's reason and understanding through argument."
- Steps: (1) understand your audience, (2) find common ground with your audience — collect ideas, (3) know the various sides of the issue and respectfully address other points of view (the **Burkean Parlor**, literature review), (4) establish your argument — thesis statement and progression of the argument.

Why care about communication skills?

The lecture illustrates the stakes with a real ad exchange: Pepsi's Halloween ad reading "We wish you a scary Halloween," and Coca-Cola's reply, "Everyone wants to be a hero" — a reminder that tone and wording carry consequences even in short, casual writing.

Types of sentences: writerly vs readerly



Same content, two styles — clear, concise writing favors readerly

Two ways to say the same thing

Worked example (a wordy, writerly original vs. its readerly rewrite)

- **Writerly:** "With the beginning of the new '80s, it is readily ascertainable that there has been little if any improvement in the overall national or general local economy. It is expected by some economists that a general upturn on the national level should come about sometime during mid-1981. However, with the increase in taxes starting in January, mainly an increase in social security, this will reduce the amount of free funds available for the stimulation of consumer spending."
- **Readerly rewrite:** "With the beginning of the '80s, there is little improvement in the local or national upturn in mid-1981. Although some economists expect an upturn in mid-1981, the increase in social security taxes scheduled for January may reduce available funds for consumer spending. In 1980 we saw little if any improvement in the economy, national or local, and although some economists expect an upturn in mid-1981, the tax increases scheduled to begin in January, mainly for social security, will leave consumers with less money to spend."

Diagnosing a wordy sentence

- **Be clear and concise.** A wordy sentence's profile usually has three faults (from Claire Kehrwald Cook, *Line by Line: How to Edit Your Own Writing*, 1985): **passive voice**, **weak verbs**, and **bulky nouns**.
- **Weak verbs** — the verb *to be* means to exist (I *am* here), to occur (the deadline *is* today), or to have a characteristic (she *was* sick): am, are, is, was, were, being, been. **Actionless verbs**: have, exist. **Passive form**: is believed, was seen.
- **Bulky nouns** end in *-tion, -ment, -ence*. Example: "The inference that... the differences may be attributed to the possession of a diploma is suspect since dropouts and graduates may differ in a variety of ways relevant to both graduation prospects and employment status" → readerly rewrite: "It is not necessarily the diploma that makes high school graduates more employable than dropouts; other differences may

affect both their education and their job prospects."

Condensation: convert bulky phrases back to verbs

Wordy	Condensed
is indicative of	indicates
have an influence on	influence
make an assessment of	assess
is capable of	can
is of interest to	interests
by the implementation of	by implementing
in the creation of	in creating
in the discussion of	in discussing
through the examination of	through examining
by the addition of	by adding

5 Negotiations: Rogerian strategy & Principled Negotiation

Lecture L10 · Negotiations and Meetings

Negotiations

One of the most important forms of professional communication is negotiating agreements between parties who have opposing views and interests.

Carl Ransom Rogers (1902–87): American psychologist known for his humanist/client-centered/person-centered approach. Championed openness, creativity, choice, reliability, and other human traits that help people progress in life and profession. Drew upon the Freudian understanding of the human self. Quote attributed to him: "We think we listen, but very rarely do we listen with real understanding, true empathy. Yet listening, of this very special kind, is one of the most potent forces for change that I know."

The Rogerian strategy (or Rogerian conflict resolution)

- The Rogerian argument (Rogerian rhetoric) is a form of argumentative reasoning that aims to establish a **middle ground** between parties with opposing viewpoints or goals.
- Developed by psychotherapist Carl Rogers and adapted to rhetoric by writing scholars **Young, Becker, and Pike (1970)**: the speaker seeks compromise by acknowledging positive aspects of each party's argument, to arrive at a mutually-beneficial solution.
- It is an optimistic yet optimal means toward conflict resolution.
- According to Rogers, when people cling to an illogical/unreasonable position and refuse to consider alternatives, it is not necessarily that they believe in that position, but because the alternatives are threatening to their self-image.
- Rogerian argumentation is not a step-by-step method but a **general strategy**, whose goal is to create an atmosphere in which meaningful negotiations can take place.
- It can be non-negotiable if parties are at loggerheads and believe in absolute opposites, or it can lead to non-optimal compromises.
- You may already use it in everyday life (e.g. compromising with a friend on what movie to watch), but it is decidedly less common in academic settings, where empirical/theoretical truth is often prized above practical advantage. It's most suited for small/focus groups and office meetings.

Key steps in a Rogerian argument



All nine steps, in order

Principled Negotiation — the four principles



More on negotiation tactics (Program on Negotiation, Harvard Law School)

- Some negotiators use **hard-bargaining tactics** — threats, extreme demands, even unethical behavior — to gain the upper hand. This treats negotiation as a win-lose enterprise. **Avoid such hard negotiations.**
- Better routes to your goals: building trust, asking lots of questions, exploring differences.
- You will inevitably feel angry, frustrated, or mistreated at times as a negotiator — be prepared with solid tactics.
- Use cooperation and be ready to compromise; look for scenarios of mutual gain; be culturally sensitive, especially in international negotiations; bring leadership qualities.
- Common places for negotiation: salary, leave, terms of joining or leaving.
- What you need: analysis, the right questions, active listening, assertiveness, preparedness, calmness.
- Film reference: *Sully: Miracle on the Hudson* (2016), about Capt. Chesley "Sully" Sullenberger — used as an example of composure and skill under pressure.

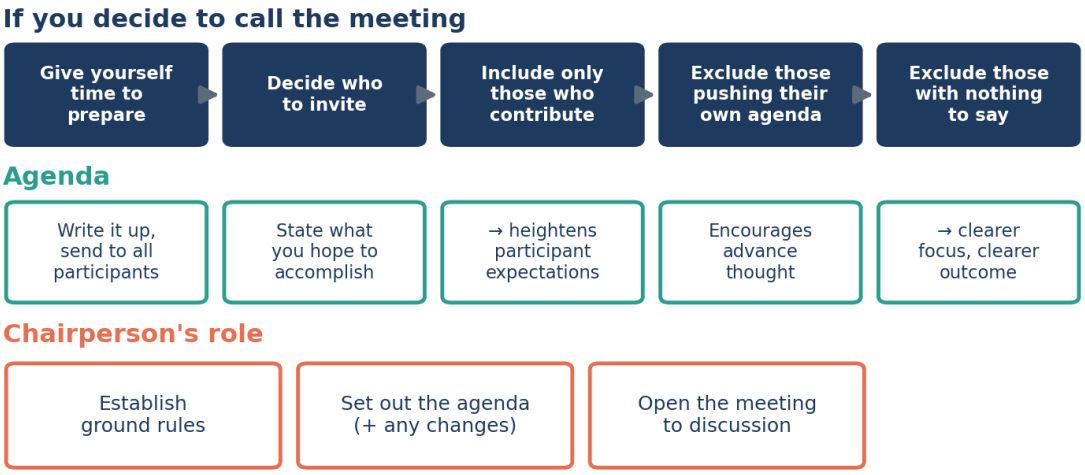
6 Meetings, virtual conferencing, resumes & applications

Lecture L11

Meetings — an essential form of communication

- Necessary in every profession.
- **When is a meeting useful?** Meetings generally work best to create consensus on an issue where possible solutions have already been carefully narrowed down. They do **not** work well for brainstorming, or when the group is just beginning to think about a problem.
- Before calling a meeting, first ask yourself: **"What do I hope to get out of it?"**

If you decide to call the meeting — prep, agenda, chairperson's role



Preparation checklist through the chair's responsibilities during discussion

Minutes of meetings (crucial for later reporting)

- Should be taken by someone **other than the chairperson**; a minute-taker should be identified well in advance.
- **Short action minutes** are generally most appropriate — they eliminate confusion and serve as the basis for appropriate follow-up.
- During the meeting: get everyone to participate, solicit everyone's view, keep participation balanced, maintain a positive constructive atmosphere, try to reach a consensus, and ask the minute-taker to briefly summarize what's been agreed to.

Tele and video conferencing

Major advantage	Disadvantages
Eliminates travel	Nonverbal communication doesn't get focus
Focuses effectively on problem-solving activities	Doesn't serve social bonding as well as physical meetings
No less effective in accuracy of information	Complicated to set up technically
Transmitted / in the amount of time required to transmit that information	Requires special preparation and presentation skills

For virtual meetings, keep in mind: your material needs to be better prepared than for an ordinary face-to-face meeting; convey expressiveness through your voice and vary your intonation; remember there can be time lags in virtual communication; get quickly to the point or maintain a steady flow of speech until you've made it.

Resume, Statement of Purpose, Job Application, Memos

It is difficult to prepare a good resume and a good cover letter unless you know: what you want to do · what you can offer · what the company or program does · what it can offer.

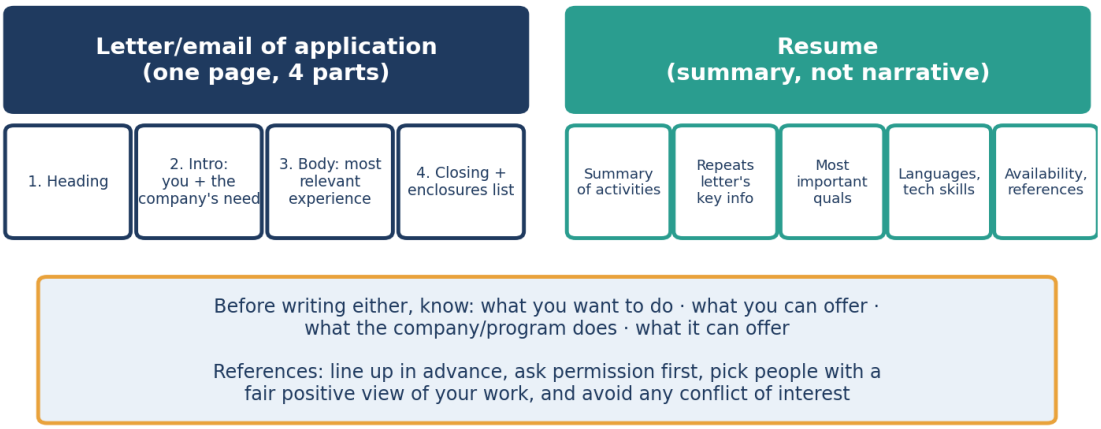
To find out what you want to do, consider:

- Your short-term and long-term goals.
- Your previous training and interests.
- Financial, geographical, and personal advantages as well as constraints.
- Technical person, or manager? Assess your previous training and interests accordingly.

About the university/institution/company

- Information in the library, online resources, or news media.
- Company/university/department publications, product reviews, annual reports and so on.
- If you know someone there, interview her/him.
- Call someone in the personnel office or a manager in one of the technical departments.

Letter of application and resume, side by side



Both stay to one page; the resume summarizes rather than narrates

Honors and extra-curricular activities

- Command of other languages.
- Technical/software expertise.
- Date on which you can start working.
- Availability of references.

References

- Make connections and contacts in advance.
- They should have a fair and positive idea of your work and credentials.
- Make sure to avoid a conflict of interest.
- Either available on request, or list your referees.
- Better to take her/his/their permission first.

7 Practice MCQs (46 questions)

Do it cold, then check the key that follows

1. What is the first step in active listening?

- **A.** Suspend judgment
- **B.** Share
- **C.** Pay full attention
- **D.** Summarize

2. Suspending judgment while listening means:

- **A.** Not imposing meaning and preconceived beliefs onto a situation
- **B.** Interrupting to correct the speaker
- **C.** Agreeing with everything the speaker says
- **D.** Refusing to respond at all

3. Reflection is described as most transformative for communication when:

- **A.** Discussing topics you already agree with
- **B.** Speaking, not listening
- **C.** Facing ideas antithetical to one's own
- **D.** Listening to a monologue

4. Summarizing in active listening should:

- **A.** Be skipped if you already understood
- **B.** Faithfully describe the essence of what the other person said, in a way they'd recognize
- **C.** Give your own conclusions instead of theirs
- **D.** Only restate the literal words used

5. Good reflecting (paraphrasing) does all of the following EXCEPT:

- **A.** Impose your own judgment on the speaker's meaning
- **B.** Communicate acceptance and respect
- **C.** Reassure the speaker they are being heard
- **D.** Sum up what the other person said

6. In public presentations, body language advice includes:

- **A.** Avoiding eye contact to reduce pressure
- **B.** Keeping a closed, judgmental posture
- **C.** Focusing on your hands and feet
- **D.** Making eye contact with the audience

7. The Rogerian strategy is best described as:

- **A.** A way to guarantee compromise every time
- **B.** A general strategy to create an atmosphere for meaningful negotiation
- **C.** A rigid, step-by-step method
- **D.** A legal framework for contracts

8. Rogerian argumentation can lead to:

- **A.** The end of all disagreement
- **B.** Non-negotiable deadlock, or non-optimal compromises, if parties are at loggerheads
- **C.** Guaranteed optimal outcomes every time
- **D.** Immediate victory for one side

9. Rogerian rhetoric was adapted from Carl Rogers' psychotherapy by which scholars, in 1970?

- **A.** Freud, Jung, and Adler
- **B.** Graff and Birkenstein
- **C.** Young, Becker, and Pike
- **D.** Fisher, Ury, and Patton

10. According to Carl Rogers, people cling to an illogical position mainly because:

- **A.** They are paid to do so
- **B.** Alternatives feel threatening to their self-image
- **C.** They lack intelligence
- **D.** They enjoy conflict

11. Which is the correct order of the first three steps in a Rogerian argument?

- **A.** Finding common ground, knowing the audience, introducing the problem
- **B.** Introducing the problem, finding common ground, knowing the audience
- **C.** Acknowledging the opposite side, conclusion, common ground
- **D.** Defining your own position, common ground, conclusion

12. The last step of the Rogerian argument is:

- **A.** Finalize by editing the main idea
- **B.** Introducing the problem
- **C.** Defining your own position
- **D.** Finding a common ground

13. Principled Negotiation was developed by:

- **A.** Young, Becker, and Pike
- **B.** Claire Kehrwald Cook
- **C.** Carl Rogers alone
- **D.** Roger Fisher, William Ury and colleagues at the Harvard Negotiation Project

14. Which is NOT one of the four principles of Principled Negotiation?

- **A.** Insist on emotionally driven judgement
- **B.** Separate the people from the problem
- **C.** Focus on interests, not positions
- **D.** Invent options for mutual gain

15. Hard-bargaining negotiation tactics are best described as:

- **A.** Always the most effective approach
- **B.** A form of Principled Negotiation
- **C.** Threats, extreme demands, and even unethical behavior to gain the upper hand
- **D.** Building trust and asking questions

16. Better routes to your negotiation goals include:

- **A.** Making extreme demands
- **B.** Building trust, asking lots of questions, exploring differences
- **C.** Ignoring cultural context
- **D.** Refusing to listen to the other party

17. What does the film Sully: Miracle on the Hudson illustrate in this context?

- **A.** A failed negotiation
- **B.** The Rogerian argument's nine steps
- **C.** A resume-writing case study
- **D.** Composure and skill under pressure, used as a negotiation-adjacent example

18. A meeting is generally most useful for:

- **A.** A group only beginning to think about a problem
- **B.** Brainstorming from a completely blank slate
- **C.** Creating consensus on an issue whose solutions are already narrowed down
- **D.** Avoiding any decision-making

19. Before calling a meeting, you should first ask:

- **A.** What do I hope to get out of it?
- **B.** Who will disagree with me?
- **C.** Can I cancel it instead?
- **D.** How long can I make it?

20. Who should you exclude from a meeting invite list?

- **A.** People who ask questions
- **B.** Everyone except the chairperson
- **C.** Anyone who disagrees with you
- **D.** Those likely to pursue their own agendas and disrupt the meeting

21. An agenda should be:

- **A.** Skipped for informal meetings only
- **B.** Written up and sent to all participants in advance
- **C.** Kept secret until the meeting begins
- **D.** Left entirely flexible with no fixed items

22. The chairperson's role includes:

- **A.** Taking the minutes personally
- **B.** Avoiding any structure
- **C.** Establishing ground rules, setting out the agenda, and opening the meeting to discussion
- **D.** Making all decisions alone

23. Minutes of a meeting should ideally be:

- **A.** Taken by the chairperson
- **B.** Verbatim transcripts of everything said
- **C.** Written only if requested afterward
- **D.** Short action minutes

24. Who should take the minutes of a meeting?

- **A.** Whoever arrives late
- **B.** Someone other than the chairperson, identified in advance
- **C.** No one — minutes aren't necessary
- **D.** The most senior person present

25. A major advantage of tele/video conferencing is:

- **A.** It requires no technical setup
- **B.** It is always shorter than in-person meetings
- **C.** It improves nonverbal communication
- **D.** It eliminates travel

26. A disadvantage of tele/video conferencing is:

- **A.** It is always cheaper
- **B.** It always improves social bonding
- **C.** Nonverbal communication doesn't get focus
- **D.** It requires no preparation

27. For virtual meetings, you should:

- **A.** Assume there is no time lag
- **B.** Prepare material even more thoroughly than for a face-to-face meeting
- **C.** Speak in a flat, uniform tone
- **D.** Rely entirely on body language

28. A resume should mainly be:

- **A.** Identical in content to your cover letter, word for word
- **B.** A list of your family's income
- **C.** A summary of your most significant qualifications
- **D.** A full narrative of your childhood

29. The letter/email of application should be:

- **A.** Longer than the resume
- **B.** One page long, with four main sections
- **C.** Written without any structure
- **D.** At least three pages long

30. The second paragraph of a letter of application should:

- **A.** Repeat the heading
- **B.** Give the most relevant experience and qualifications
- **C.** List hobbies only
- **D.** Be left blank

31. Before choosing referees, you should:

- **A.** Choose only next-of-kin for authenticity
- **B.** Pick people who have never met you
- **C.** Make connections and contacts in advance, and get their permission
- **D.** Avoid telling them you're using them as a reference

32. Honors and extra-curricular details on a resume include:

- **A.** Your salary expectations
- **B.** Your family background
- **C.** Command of other languages and technical/software expertise
- **D.** Confidential company data

33. Persuasive writing, per the Purdue Writing Lab, seeks to:

- **A.** Avoid the audience's perspective entirely
- **B.** Simply state facts with no argument
- **C.** Confuse the reader with complex syntax
- **D.** Convince readers to embrace a viewpoint by appealing to reason and understanding through argument

34. The first step in effective persuasion is to:

- **A.** Understand your audience
- **B.** Write the conclusion first
- **C.** Avoid research entirely
- **D.** Attack the opposing view immediately

35. 'Know the various sides of the issue' in persuasive writing connects to which earlier course concept?

- **A.** Modernism
- **B.** The Communication process only
- **C.** The Burkean Parlor / literature review
- **D.** The Freytag pyramid

36. Readerly writing is characterized by being:

- **A.** Written mainly in the passive voice
- **B.** Simple, precise, chronological, without contradictions or complexity
- **C.** Full of bulky nouns
- **D.** Dense and demanding of the reader

37. A wordy sentence's profile typically includes:

- **A.** Excess dialogue
- **B.** Only short sentences
- **C.** Passive voice, weak verbs, and bulky nouns
- **D.** Too many active verbs

38. Which is an example of a weak verb?

- **A.** implements, creates, discusses
- **B.** runs, jumps, writes
- **C.** is, was, were, being
- **D.** indicates, assesses, interests

39. Bulky nouns typically end in:

- **A.** -tion, -ment, -ence
- **B.** -ing, -ed, -er
- **C.** -able, -ive, -ent
- **D.** -ly, -ous, -ful

40. 'Is indicative of' condenses to:

- **A.** Indicates
- **B.** Discusses
- **C.** Assesses
- **D.** Is capable of

41. 'Make an assessment of' condenses to:

- **A.** Indicate
- **B.** Discuss
- **C.** Interest
- **D.** Assess

42. According to L9, the Pepsi/Coca-Cola Halloween ad exchange illustrates:

- **A.** Why communication skills matter, even in short, casual writing
- **B.** A resume-writing principle
- **C.** A negotiation tactic
- **D.** The Rogerian argument in practice

43. Which style manuals does L7 list for technical/scientific research writing?

- **A.** MLA and Chicago
- **B.** IEEE and APA
- **C.** None of the above
- **D.** Harvard only

44. In the 'They Say, I Say' template, remaining undecided in the body should sound like:

- **A.** "I completely agree with everything X says."
- **B.** "I refuse to take a position."
- **C.** "I am on two minds about ___. On the one hand I agree that ___. On the other hand, I am not sure whether ___."
- **D.** "X is entirely wrong and always will be."

45. Passive voice is acceptable when:

- **A.** The actor is unknown, irrelevant, deliberately vague, or you're stating a general truth
- **B.** You are certain who did the action and want to emphasize them
- **C.** Writing for a technical audience only
- **D.** You want the sentence to be longer

46. Parallel structure requires that:

- **A.** Verbs always precede nouns
- **B.** Every sentence be the same length
- **C.** Pairs and lists follow the same grammatical pattern
- **D.** Every sentence use the passive voice

✓ Answer key

With a one-line reason for each

#	Ans	Why
1	C	Step 1 of the six steps.
2	A	Judgment imposes meaning/preconceived beliefs; suspending it avoids that.
3	C	Precisely when it's most challenging, per the notes.
4	B	Fosters connection and trust by mirroring their intent, not just your take.
5	A	Good reflecting is explicitly non-judgmental.
6	D	Also: stay relaxed, be humble and sincere, be welcoming.
7	B	Not step-by-step; a general strategy.
8	B	The notes explicitly flag this limitation.
9	C	Named directly in L10.
10	B	Not because they necessarily believe the position itself.
11	A	Steps 1-2-3 in order.
12	A	Step 9, the final step.
13	D	Harvard Negotiation Project, founded 1979.
14	A	The fourth real principle is 'insist on using objective criteria', not emotional judgement.
15	C	The PON blog advises avoiding these.
16	B	Explicitly recommended alternatives to hard bargaining.
17	D	Referenced alongside negotiation tactics.
18	C	Explicitly stated in L11.
19	A	The first question the notes recommend.
20	D	Also exclude those with nothing to say.
21	B	Circulating it heightens expectations and encourages preparation.
22	C	Minutes should be taken by someone other than the chair.
23	D	Action minutes eliminate confusion and support follow-up.
24	B	Explicit in L11.
25	D	Listed as the major advantage.
26	C	Listed among the disadvantages.
27	B	Convey expressiveness through voice since body language reads poorly on screen.
28	C	It repeats some/most letter info but stays a summary, not a narrative.
29	B	Heading, intro, body, closing + enclosures.
30	B	Per the 'Designing the Letter/Email of Application' slide.
31	C	Also: avoid conflicts of interest; fair positive view of your work.
32	C	Also: start date, availability of references.
33	D	Direct quote from L9.
34	A	Then: find common ground, know various sides, establish your argument.
35	C	L9 explicitly ties this step to the Burkean Parlor idea.
36	B	Opposite of writerly writing.
37	C	Per Claire Kehrwald Cook's Line by Line (1985).
38	C	Forms of 'to be' and actionless verbs like have/exist are weak.
39	A	Per the Condensation slide.
40	A	Direct example from the slide.
41	D	Direct example from the slide.

#	Ans	Why
42	**A**	Used as a 'why care about communication skills' example.
43	**B**	MLA/Chicago/Harvard/APA are for social sciences and humanities instead.
44	**C**	The undecided template from L7.
45	**A**	Per L8: 'Mistakes were made'; 'Rules are made to be broken', etc.
46	**C**	'Skating and reading', not 'skating and to read'.

Past-paper appendix

Transcribed from your uploaded scan, question text only

Source and method

The uploaded file is a phone-photographed, graded answer script of two quizzes from an earlier offering of this course: **Quiz 1** and **Quiz 2**, Communication Skills (LA 1760/10760), IIT Hyderabad, each worth 50 marks. Both follow the exact format your course announced: bubble-sheet MCQs, no negative marking, 5 lettered sections.

The pages that follow reproduce the **question text and options exactly as printed**, with section headers and instructions verbatim. The scanned copy is a **graded** script — it carries a student's pencil-filled bubbles and a grader's red-pen marks. Those marks belong to one student's attempt, not to the exam itself, so they are **not reproduced here**; only the questions and answer choices are transcribed.

One gap: Quiz 1's page 6 was not present in the scan. It held the header and first four questions (26–29) of Section D, a five-question reading passage (about Mesoamerican pyramids) parallel in structure to Sections C and E. Only question 30, the last of that section, survived on the following page — it is included below with the missing context noted.

Q1 Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad — Quiz 1

Communication Skills (LA 1760) · Maximum Marks: 50

General Instructions: please read very carefully:

- This question paper has 5 questions, A to E
- Use a blue/black pen
- Fill the correct answer as a bubble
- If two options are simultaneously chosen for one question, it will be marked wrong
- Read instructions very carefully and answer all questions
- Write your name and roll number
- No negative marking
- Use of mobile phones/internet not allowed

A. Carefully read the following questions on academic/professional communication and choose the most appropriate answer (1×10=10 marks)

1. In academic/formal writing it is fine to be

a. Controversial and insulting
b. Biased and inflexible
c. Undecided yet informed
d. None of the above

2. For writing well informed formal articles, one should

a. Never repeat what has been said
b. Refer but with acknowledgements
c. Always and only refer to others
d. Try only self-referencing

3. While disagreeing with existing scholarship as you write an article, you must

a. Back your criticism with facts
b. Aggressively attack what you disagree with
c. Simply ignore what you disagree with
d. All of the above

4. When you write an academic article by foregrounding your own position on a topic, you should

a. Strongly claim the validity of your arguments
b. Provide facts supporting the validity of your arguments
c. Avoid all existing scholarly references on the topic
d. None of the above

5. In an academic article if you agree with existing scholarship but have more information to add, you should

a. Acknowledge existing information
b. Claim you are bridging a gap in scholarship
c. Provide your own take on the issue
d. All of the above

6. While writing a formal article, if you choose to agree and disagree simultaneously with existing scholarship you should

a. Ignore the ideas you disagree with
b. Provide facts for your disagreement
c. Never mention reasons for your disagreement
d. Provoke readers to disagree along with you

7. As you conclude a formal article, you should

a. Reiterate your larger argument
b. Never repeat yourself
c. Try using others' ideas to support your own
d. All of the above

8. A thesis statement helps you in

a. Summarizing data you will reject
b. Summarizing your central argument
c. Summarizing your data collection
d. None of the above

9. As you begin working on a formal piece of written communication that will be read by others, it is most important that you keep in mind

a. Your own background
b. Who your reader is
c. Whether you like the topic or not
d. None of the above

10. Historically, most human communication has been about

a. Passing information
b. Having fun
c. Keeping secrets
d. Forgetting incidents

B. From the following questions on communication in its various forms, choose the most appropriate answer (1×10=10 marks)

11. Academic plagiarism includes

a. Unacknowledged copying
b. Duplication of others' ideas
c. Using others' ideas and claiming originality
d. All of the above
e. None of the above

12. To avoid plagiarism, one should

a. Stop borrowing others' ideas
b. Use existing ideas with proper acknowledgement
c. Never acknowledge borrowing others' ideas
d. None of the above

13. While using AI for getting solutions for academic questions, it is important to remember that

a. AI is programmed to respond to all questions
b. AI requires human scrutiny
c. AI is likely to have algorithmic bias
d. All of the above
e. None of the above

14. One of the most important things scholars need to do with AI is

a. Ensure that inclusive and unbiased data is used
b. Ensure that all AI systems are developed in Western laboratories alone
c. Ensure that only highly technically trained individuals use AI
d. All of the above

15. When using AI for academic writing, one must

a. Ensure attribution of source
b. Double check against bias and inaccuracy
c. Never copy without acknowledgement
d. All of the above

16. One of the main concerns with using AI for mitigating human problems is

a. Data generated can be faulty and inaccurate
b. Data generated can be from global sources
c. Data generated is available very fast
d. All of the above

17. To be an empathetic communicator, one needs to

a. Try correcting the other person's mistakes
b. Amuse the other person
c. Try being in the other person's shoes
d. Try avoiding the other person

18. In effective communication, one needs to be

a. Firm and aggressive
b. Firm and submissive
c. Firm and amusing
d. Firm and polite

19. In formal communication, the best way to handle criticism is to

a. Distinguish between hurtful and helpful criticism
b. Aggressively fight back to stop the critic
c. Reject all criticism and keep working
d. All of the above

20. Humor in formal communication

a. Should be avoided at all costs
b. Should always be present
c. Should be used to diffuse unpleasantness
d. Should be used to ridicule others

C. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

Saving energy means saving money. Homeowners and renters know this basic fact, but they often don't know what kinds of adjustments they can make in their homes and apartments that will result in savings.

For those willing to spend some time and money to reap long-term energy savings, an energy audit is the way to go. An energy auditor will come into your home and assess its energy efficiency. The auditor will pinpoint areas of your home that use the most energy and offer solutions to lower your energy use and costs. Trained energy auditors know what to look for and can locate a variety of flaws that may be resulting in energy inefficiency, including inadequate insulation, construction flaws, and uneven heat distribution.

There are quicker and less costly measures that can be taken as well. One way to save money is to replace incandescent lights with fluorescents. This can result in a savings of more than 50% on your monthly lighting costs.

When it's time to replace old appliances, it's wise to spend a bit more for an energy-efficient model, and be sure that you are taking advantage of energy-saving settings already on your current refrigerator, dishwasher, washing machine, or dryer.

Windows provide another opportunity to cut your energy costs. Caulk old windows that might be leaky to prevent drafts, and choose double-paned windows if you're building an addition or replacing old windows.

Most areas of your home or apartment offer opportunities to save energy and money. The results are significant and are well worth the effort.

21. Which two main organizational schemes can be identified in this passage?

a. hierarchical order and order by topic
b. order by topic and cause and effect
c. hierarchical order and chronological order
d. chronological order and compare and contrast

22. Which of the following ideas is NOT included in this passage?

a. You can reduce your $130 monthly lighting costs to $65 by using fluorescent bulbs instead of incandescent.
b. Double-paned windows can cut energy costs.
c. Your local energy company will send an energy auditor at your request.
d. Some appliances have energy-saving settings.

23. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?

a. There are many things a homeowner or renter can do to save energy and money.
b. Hiring an energy auditor will save energy and money.
c. Homeowners and renters don't know what they can do to save energy and money.
d. Replacing windows and light bulbs are well worth the effort and cost.

24. According to the passage, which of the following would an energy auditor NOT do?

a. Check for construction flaws.
b. Look for problems with heat distribution.
c. Offer solutions to lower your energy costs.
d. Locate a variety of flaws that may result in energy inefficiency and fix them.

25. According to the passage, double-paned windows

a. are energy efficient.
b. should only be used as replacement windows.
c. should only be used in new additions to homes.
d. will lower your heating costs by 50%.

D. [Section header and passage not in the scan]

> Page 6 of this quiz — the section header, a five-question reading passage (about Mesoamerican pyramids), and questions 26–29 — was not present in the uploaded file. Only question 30, the last question of the section, survives on the next page.

30. The passage tells us that Mesoamerican pyramids were

a. Very strong in their architecture
b. Took a lot of time to build
c. Were not meant to survive very long
d. Were made of moss

E. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

During those barren winter months, with windows overlooking long-dead gardens, leafless trees, and lawns that seem to have an ashy look about them, nothing soothes the jangled nerves more than the vibrant green of plants surrounding the living spaces of one's home. People browse through greenhouses just to get a whiff of chlorophyll and to choose a plant or two to bring spring back into their winter gray lives.

Now there is even more of a need for "the green," in light of recent articles warning us of the hazards of chemicals that we, ourselves, introduce into our homes. Each time we bring clothes home from the cleaners, we release those chemicals into the closed-in air of our dwellings. Every cleanser brings its own assortment of fumes. Some of the chemicals are formaldehyde, chlorine, benzene, styrene, etc. Read the labels on many home products; the ingredients aren't even listed! During the winter, when those same windows are shut tight, we breathe in these chemicals — causing symptoms much like allergies. In fact, most people probably dismiss the effects of these chemicals simply as a flare up of a winter allergy or other.

The truth is that we are experiencing a syndrome that is called Multiple Chemical Sensitivity. Now, what has this got to do with green plants? Everything healthy! Research has been conducted with two types of plants that have actually removed much of these harmful chemicals from the air.

The two plants that seem to be the best bet for ridding one's home of such chemicals are ferns and palms. These plants release moisture as part of photosynthesis and, as they do, pull chemicals from the air into their leaves. Even NASA has conducted some greenhouse experiments for long-term space exploration. Within hours, their plants [palms] had removed almost all traces of formaldehyde in the room. Both species of plants are ancient, dating back more than a hundred million years. Another trait they share is that they both live long lives, 100 years or more. This we expect from trees, but ferns and palms are plants; plants that can grow to 65 feet in the proper setting! Even their individual leaves live on — one to two years [ferns] and one to nine years [palms]. Perhaps it is their primal qualities that have contributed to their ability to purify their environment.

31. What is the main idea of the passage?

a. Our homes are full of contaminants.
b. Our allergies are caused by chemicals found in the home.
c. All plants release moisture in the home.
d. Certain plants can purify the home of many harmful chemicals.

32. According to the passage, when a few harmful chemicals combine, they can

a. cause us to experience allergies.
b. cause a monumental task for homeowners.
c. contribute to a syndrome called Multiple Chemical Sensitivity.
d. contribute to photosynthesis in plants.

33. The passage indicates that research

a. has only been conducted using specific plants.
b. has only been conducted by NASA.
c. has not identified the sources of these chemical impurities.
d. has only benefited long-term space exploration.

34. The passage infers a relationship between the antiquity of ferns and palms and their ability to

a. live long.
b. purify the air.
c. grow leaves that live long.
d. react successfully in research experiments.

35. A good title for this passage is

a. Research in the New Millennium.
b. Home Dangers.
c. Common Houseplants May Purify Your Home.
d. NASA Experiment Finds the Cure.

Q2 Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad — Quiz 2

Communication Skills (LA 1760) · Maximum Marks: 50

General Instructions: please read very carefully:

- This question paper has 5 questions, A to E
- Use a blue/black pen
- Fill the correct answer as a bubble
- If two options are simultaneously chosen for one question, it will be marked wrong
- Read instructions very carefully and answer all questions
- Write your name and roll number
- No negative marking
- Use of mobile phones/internet not allowed

A. Carefully read the following questions on academic/professional communication and choose the most appropriate answer (1×10=10 marks)

1. Official meetings should ideally be convened for

a. Brainstorming on pertinent topics
b. Creating official network within one's organization
c. Finding carefully planned solution through consensus
d. None of the above

2. Where agenda in official meetings is concerned, it should

a. Be left entirely flexible and changeable
b. Be circulated in advance
c. Be kept confidential till meeting begins
d. All of the above

3. Minutes of meetings are crucial because

a. They help sticking to the time limit set for a meeting
b. They provide a job for the minute taker
c. They help avoid confusion once the meeting is over
d. None of the above

4. During virtual meetings it is important to

a. Keep presentations ready in advance
b. Maintain composure in one's voice and tone
c. Stick to the main point of discussion
d. All of the above

5. A well-written resume should definitely contain

a. Summary of one's childhood experiences
b. Summary of one's most significant qualifications
c. Summary of one's family income
d. All of the above

6. While taking letters of reference for the resume, one should

a. Never disturb referees by contacting them in advance
b. Choose referees who have a fair and positive idea of one's credentials
c. Choose referees who are next of kin for authenticity
d. None of the above

7. Rogerian argument in meetings brings about

a. A reconciliation between entirely opposing ideals
b. A situation promoting the corporate rat race
c. A platform for meaningful business negotiations
d. A situation leading to creation of trade unions

8. According to the Harvard Negotiation Project, Principled Negotiation leads to

a. Emotionally driven judgement on official issues
b. Victory of one party over another
c. Focus on one party's interest over another
d. Possible options being created for mutual gain

9. To be a productive participant in a business meeting, one should be

a. A vocal critic of all ideas presented
b. An active social agent who exposes confidential issues
c. A supportive and perceptive listener
d. All of the above

10. An official memo or report is usually meant for

a. Only the scientific advisers of an organization
b. All office workers who regularly read newspapers
c. Only the regular clients of an organization
d. The manager and other non-expert readers in an organization

B. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

On February 3, 1956, Autherine Lucy became the first African-American student to attend the University of Alabama, although the dean of women refused to allow Autherine to live in a university dormitory. White students rioted in protest of her admission, and the federal government had to assume command of the Alabama National Guard in order to protect her. Nonetheless, on her first day in class, Autherine bravely took a seat in the front row. She remembers being surprised that the professor of the class appeared not to notice she was even in class. Later, she would appreciate his seeming indifference, as he was one of only a few professors to speak out in favor of her right to attend the university.

For protection, Autherine was taken in and out of classroom buildings by the back door and driven from class to class by an assistant to the university president. The students continued to riot, and one day, the windshield of the car she was in was broken. University officials suspended her, saying it was for her own safety. When her attorney issued a statement in her name protesting her suspension, the university used it as grounds for expelling her for insubordination. Although she never finished her education at the University of Alabama, Autherine Lucy's courage was an inspiration to African-American students who followed her lead and desegregated universities all over the United States.

11. According to the passage, what did Autherine Lucy do on her first day at the University of Alabama?

a. She moved into a dormitory.
b. She sat in the front row of her class.
c. She became terrified of the white rioters.
d. She was befriended by an assistant to the university president.

12. Based on the information in the passage, which of the following best describes Autherine Lucy?

a. quiet and shy
b. courageous and determined
c. clever and amusing
d. overly dramatic

13. When she began classes at the university, Autherine Lucy expected to

a. stand out from the other students.
b. have the support of the university faculty.
c. join an African-American organization for protection.
d. be ridiculed by the professors.

14. Autherine Lucy never graduated from the University of Alabama because she

a. moved to another state.
b. transferred to another university.
c. dropped out because of pressure from other students.
d. was expelled for insubordination.

15. According to the passage, which of the following is true?

a. The Alabama National Guard is normally under the command of the U.S. Army.
b. In 1956, the only segregated university in the United States was in Alabama.
c. Autherine Lucy was escorted to and from class by the university president's assistant.
d. A few white students at the university were pleased that Autherine Lucy was a student there.

C. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

> The same energy-saving passage as Quiz 1, Section C, reused here as questions 16–20.

16. Which two main organizational schemes can be identified in this passage?

a. hierarchical order and order by topic
b. order by topic and cause and effect
c. hierarchical order and chronological order
d. chronological order and compare and contrast

17. Which of the following ideas is NOT included in this passage?

a. You can reduce your $130 monthly lighting costs to $65 by using fluorescent bulbs instead of incandescent.
b. Double-paned windows can cut energy costs.
c. Your local energy company will send an energy auditor at your request.
d. Some appliances have energy-saving settings.

18. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?

a. There are many things a homeowner or renter can do to save energy and money.
b. Hiring an energy auditor will save energy and money.
c. Homeowners and renters don't know what they can do to save energy and money.
d. Replacing windows and light bulbs are well worth the effort and cost.

19. According to the passage, which of the following would an energy auditor NOT do?

a. Check for construction flaws.
b. Look for problems with heat distribution.
c. Offer solutions to lower your energy costs.
d. Locate a variety of flaws that may result in energy inefficiency and fix them.

20. According to the passage, double-paned windows

a. are energy efficient.
b. should only be used as replacement windows.
c. should only be used in new additions to homes.
d. will lower your heating costs by 50%.

D. Vocabulary: Read the following sentences and try to choose the best definition for the italicized word by searching for context clues in the sentence (1×10=10 marks)

21. The designer window treatments in her house, installed 17 years ago, were *outmoded*.

a. unnecessary
b. pointless
c. out-of-date
d. worthless

22. Although the professor's lectures were regarded by many as so *wearisome* that they regularly put students to sleep, he ignored all criticism and refused to make any changes.

a. modest
b. unpleasant
c. boring
d. objectionable

23. The baseball player's *malice* toward the referee was revealed in his spiteful remarks to the media, which almost ruined the referee's career.

a. vindictive
b. crazy
c. rude
d. unpleasant

24. Although Zachary is much too inexperienced for the managerial position, he is a willful young man and *obdurately* refuses to withdraw his application.

a. foolishly
b. reluctantly
c. constantly
d. stubbornly

25. His neighbor's *superficial* remarks trivialized the property line dispute and infuriated Malcolm.

a. enraged
b. petty
c. insulting
d. misleading

26. When Katya refused to lie to her parents about where she was spending the night, she was completely *ostracized* by her usually loyal friends, who had never shunned her before.

a. excluded
b. hurt
c. cheered
d. helped

27. Her fashion sense was usually described as flamboyant, but on the night of the party, Tanya's outfit was uncharacteristically *modest*.

a. impeccable
b. showy
c. sloppy
d. unassuming

28. Mr. Powers was so *gullible* that he believed even the most outlandish excuses of his insincere employees.

a. intelligent
b. naive
c. dishonest
d. critical

29. You cannot become a certified teacher without completing the *prerequisite* student teaching assignment.

a. required
b. optional
c. preferred
d. advisable

30. Charles, aware of his susceptibility to gum disease, is *diligent* about flossing.

a. uncomfortable
b. excited
c. thorough
d. ambivalent

E. Find the most appropriate pair of words following the analogy given in the question (1×10=10 marks)

31. LAYER : TIER

a. section : segment
b. dais : speaker
c. curtain : stage
d. chapter : verse
e. cotton : bale

32. METROPOLITAN : URBAN

a. bucolic : rural
b. sleepy : nocturnal
c. agricultural : cow
d. autumn : harvest
e. agrarian : generous

33. TEACHER : SCHOOL

a. actor : role
b. mechanic : engine
c. jockey : horse
d. judge : courthouse
e. author : book

34. PERSIAN : CAT

a. alligator : crocodile
b. zebra : reptile
c. parakeet : bird
d. rat : marsupial
e. fly : bee

35. RUN : JOG

a. trot : race
b. swim : dive
c. dance : ballet
d. juggle : bounce
e. rain : drizzle

36. SKEIN : YARN

a. squeeze : lemon
b. fire : coal
c. ream : paper
d. tree : lumber
e. plow : acre

37. TAILOR : SUIT

a. scheme : agent
b. edit : manuscript
c. revise : writer
d. mention : opinion
e. implode : building

38. CONDUCTOR : ORCHESTRA

a. jockey : mount
b. thrasher : hay
c. driver : tractor
d. skipper : crew
e. painter : house

39. JAUNDICE : LIVER

a. rash : skin
b. dialysis : kidney
c. smog : lung
d. valentine : heart
e. imagination : brain

40. COBBLER : SHOE

a. jockey : horse
b. contractor : building
c. mason : stone
d. cowboy : boot
e. potter : paint

★ Trend analysis across both past papers (updated)

Now cross-checked against L7–L11 and the meetings/negotiation lecture notes

Fixed structure, every time

- Both papers are exactly **5 sections, A–E**, bubble-sheet, no negative marking.
- Both run to **50 marks** in the same shape: two 10-question, 1-mark concept sections (A, B), then one or more passages at 2 marks a question, then (in Quiz 2 only) a 10-question vocabulary-in-context section and a 10-question verbal-analogy section.
- Every passage-based question is phrased **"choose the most appropriate answer"** — several options are partly true, and the task is picking the best-supported one.

The reading passages are reused wholesale

- The **energy-audit passage** appears twice, word-for-word, across these two papers — the same passage, same five questions, just renumbered.
- None of the three reading passages (energy audits, Autherine Lucy, houseplants) relate to your course content — they're generic reading-comprehension pieces, exactly matching the course's promise of comprehension passages drawn from general content.

Vocabulary and analogies stay general-knowledge

- Quiz 2's vocabulary-in-context and verbal-analogy sections test general vocabulary and word relationships, not anything taught in class. If your own quiz has these, the only prep is practicing that format generally.

Resolved: Quiz 2's concept section (meetings, agendas, minutes, resumes, referees, Rogerian argument, Harvard Negotiation Project's Principled Negotiation) previously looked like it came from an unseen later lecture. It now matches almost line for line:

- "Rogerian argument in meetings brings about a platform for meaningful business negotiations" → L10's Rogerian strategy section, and the Lecture Notes' Rogerian Strategy summary.
- "Principled Negotiation leads to possible options being created for mutual gain" → the fourth bullet of L10's Principled Negotiation slide, word for word.
- "A well-written resume should contain a summary of one's most significant qualifications" → L11's 'Designing the Resume' slide, and the Lecture Notes' 'Designing the Resume' section.
- "Choose referees who have a fair and positive idea of one's credentials" → L11's References slide and the Lecture Notes' References section, almost verbatim.
- "Official meetings should ideally be convened for finding carefully planned solution through consensus" → L11's "generally work best to create a consensus on some issue where the possible solutions have already been carefully narrowed down."
- "Minutes of meetings are crucial because they help avoid confusion once the meeting is over" → L11's "Minutes of Meetings are crucial for later reporting and action," and the action-minutes point on the same slide.

What this means for your prep

- This confirms the past paper's Quiz 2 was built from essentially the same meetings/negotiation/resume unit now in this guide (Sections 1, 5, and 6) — not a coincidence, and not a different course offering.
- Treat that unit as **high-yield**: the concept questions in your own Quiz 2 are likely to be this direct a paraphrase of the slides, the same way Quiz 1's concept questions were direct paraphrases of the writing-ethics and AI lectures.
- Keep drilling comprehension technique and general vocabulary/analogies separately, since those sections draw from a fixed, non-course-specific bank.